

ASTERALES

Eleven families make up the Asterales. The largest is the daisy family (Asteraceae) with some 25,000 species. Typically, each flower-like head (capitula) has many individual flowers, called florets, surrounded by showy rays. Some of the bellflower family (Campanulaceae) show similar characteristics. This order also includes the bogbean (Menyanthaceae) and fan-flower (Goodeniaceae) families, and seven smaller families.



SUNFLOWER
Helianthus annuus
F: Asteraceae

Probably Mexican in origin, this tall annual is grown as an ornamental as well as commercially for its seeds that contain 27–40 per cent polyunsaturated oil and 13–20 per cent protein.



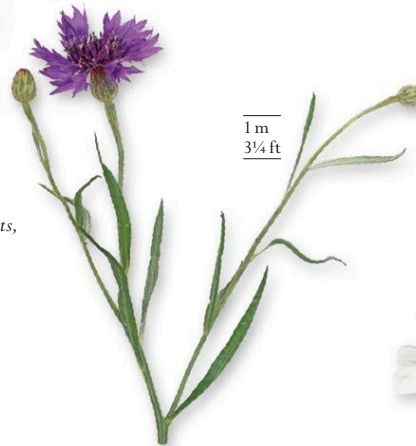
DAISY
Bellis perennis
F: Asteraceae

Originally from Europe and W. Asia, this short perennial of grazed grasslands and lawns has been transported almost worldwide. It is commonly considered a weed.



MICHAELMAS DAISY
Symphotrichum novi-belgii
F: Asteraceae

Previously classified as a species of *Aster*, this showy, variable garden plant is a native of eastern N. America.



CORNFLOWER
Centaurea cyanus
F: Asteraceae

Probably native to S. Europe and W. Asia, cornflower seeds were inseparable from corn seeds, making it a pestilential agricultural weed before herbicides.



OXEYE DAISY
Leucanthemum vulgare
F: Asteraceae

One of the most common white-flowered daisies of Europe and W. Asia, this variable patch-forming perennial quickly seeds into disturbed ground.



COMMON DANDELION
Taraxacum officinale
F: Asteraceae

The name for this familiar weed covers an amazing diversity of minutely differing forms, with perhaps 1,000 recognized "microspecies" in Europe and Asia.



PURPLE CONEFLOWER
Echinacea purpurea
F: Asteraceae

Named after the cone shape of its central disc florets, this ornamental perennial from eastern N. America is cultivated for herbal remedies against colds and flu.

SALSIFY
Tragopogon porrifolius
F: Asteraceae

A biennial herb of grassy places around the Mediterranean, salsify has lilac or reddish-purple flowerheads, surrounded by longer, pointed bracts.



COMMON RAGWORT
Jacobaea vulgaris
F: Asteraceae

Toxic to farm animals and avoided by rabbits, this native perennial from Europe and W. Asia has invaded grasslands almost worldwide.